

Petition 4 — Special Status and Pollution-Category Parity for the Coir (De-fibring & Pith) Industry in Chittur

To: Shri P.K. Kunhalikutty Hon'ble Minister for Industries & Commerce, Government of Kerala
Thiruvananthapuram

Copy to: 1. Shri Ramesh Chennithala, Hon'ble Minister in charge of Coir 2. The Chairman, Kerala State Pollution Control Board

From: The Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, Chittur Taluk, Palakkad District — represented by [Name, designation] and delegation.

Through: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur Constituency.

Date: 15 July 2026, Thiruvananthapuram.

Subject: Request for special status and pollution-category parity for coir de-fibring and coir-pith processing units in Chittur, so that the coir industry can develop within Kerala instead of migrating across the border to Pollachi (Tamil Nadu).

1. Respected Sir,

Chittur adjoins the Pollachi belt of Tamil Nadu and has abundant coconut and coir-husk availability. Yet the primary coir-processing industry has migrated almost entirely to Pollachi, chiefly because of a **difference in pollution-control classification** between the two States. We pray for a level playing field.

2. The factual position

- 1. The classification gap.** The primary coir processes — **coconut-husk retting, de-fibring, and coir-pith processing** — are treated far more stringently by the Kerala State Pollution Control Board (historically in the **Red / Orange** category) than in Tamil Nadu. In **October 2023 the Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board withdrew its earlier "Orange" reclassification and retained coir husk-retting, de-fibring and pith-processing in the "White" (practically non-polluting) category.**
- 2. The consequence.** Because of this gap, the **polluting / primary processes (de-fibring, pith buffering) are carried out in Pollachi**, while only value-addition (mats, yarn, mattings, geotextiles) is done in Kerala. Coir entrepreneurs — including many from Kerala — have set up primary units in Pollachi, taking away investment, jobs and the value of our own coconut husk.
- 3. CPCB norms actually permit a lighter category.** The Central Pollution Control Board's own methodology and its 2023 draft / 2025 classification place coir at a **much lighter category than Red:** - Coir fibre / pith processing generating effluent — **Green**; - Coir fibre / pith processing and manufacture of coir products by **dry process — White**; - Only coir **bleaching / dyeing / printing — Orange**.

In other words, a blanket Red/Orange treatment of ordinary de-fibring and dry pith processing in Kerala is **stricter than the CPCB norm requires**, and Kerala can align without diluting genuine environmental safeguards.

3. Our prayer

We humbly request the Hon'ble Minister, in coordination with the Coir portfolio and the Kerala State Pollution Control Board, to:

- 1. Re-align the pollution-category of coir de-fibring and dry coir-pith processing** in Kerala to **Green / White**, consistent with the CPCB 2016 methodology and the 2023/2025 classification, so that such units are viable in Chittur while dyeing/bleaching alone remains regulated.

2. Grant **special coir-cluster / coir industrial-zone status for Chittur**, with a Special Purpose Vehicle and a **Common Facility Centre** (mechanised de-fibring, pith washing / block-making with **Zero-Liquid-Discharge and effluent / salinity management**), so that environmental concerns are addressed collectively and cost-effectively.
3. Provide **fiscal incentives** — capital subsidy, interest subvention, and **power-tariff parity with Tamil Nadu** — to attract coir units to Chittur.
4. Ensure a **level playing field with Pollachi** so that the value addition to Kerala's own coconut husk is retained within Kerala, generating local employment.

4. Annexures (to be attached)

- Annexure A: Comparative note — KSPCB vs. TNPCB coir classification and CPCB norms.
- Annexure B: Estimated husk availability and employment potential in Chittur.

Respectfully submitted,

For and on behalf of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara

[Name, Designation] [Phone / Email]

Endorsed by: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur